Oregon Department of Human Services

Licensed Child Caring Agency Unannounced Site Visit Report

Licensee:
J Bar J - The Academy at Sisters
Executive Director: Stephanie Alvstad
Date of Unannounced: 09.23.2024
Licensing Coordinator: Aubrey Kelly

Purpose: Per OAR 419-400-0240 (1)(b) Children's Care Licensing is required to perform at least one unannounced site visit a year where children in care reside.

Previous Findings License Renewal Site Visit 06/10/2024	**Repeat Findings Further Action Needed**	**Comments**
419-400-0090 (1)(B)(b) Licensing Umbrella Rules: Children and Families Rights Policy and Grievance Procedures. (1) Rights of children in care and families served by the child-caring agency. A child-caring agency must guarantee the rights of children in care and the families the child-caring agency serves. A child-caring agency must enact and adhere to a policy ensuring those rights. A written copy must be distributed to all children in care and families served by the child-caring agency,and afford the following rights: a) Except as provided in paragraph (B) of this subsection, the child in care's right to uncensored communication with legal guardians, caseworkers, legal representatives, and	**Yes✓ No☐**	Clients reported there is no privacy when talking with parents and/or guardians. The program reported to CCLP there is a lack of space for clients to have private calls. The program also reported calls are monitored due to staff being concerned clients will plan to run away, for example, if not monitored. **The program shall ensure all clients have uncensored communications with legal guardians**.

other persons approved for communication by the legal guardian or as provided in a court order. (B) A child-caring agency may place reasonable limits on communication, but only as provided in the child-caring agency's policy. Reasonable limits include, but are not limited to, having set time periods during the day for visitation and phone calls and imposing moderate limits on the duration of calls or visits. However, a limitation is not considered reasonable if it prevents the ability to meaningfully communicate, such as not allowing contact with a child in care's attorney during regular business hours. (b) The child in care's right to **privacy**. **Clients reported while talking on the phone with their parents (legal guardians), staff are monitoring the call and if the client uses a swear word or talks negatively about the program, the staff immediately end the phone call. The program shall ensure all clients have privacy while speaking with their legal guardians.**		
419-400-0090 (2)(a) Licensing Umbrella Rules: Children and Families Rights Policy and Grievance Procedures. (2) Grievance Procedures. (a) A child-caring agency must enact and adhere to written procedures for the children in care and families the child-caring agency serves to submit a grievance. For an academic boarding school, this subsection only applies to grievances about health or safety issues. The child-caring agency	**Yes☐ No✓**	Two grievances were filed since the program's two-year licensing review. CCLP reviewed the grievance documentation, and the program followed their policy regarding the grievances.

must provide the procedures to each child in care and family. **Clients reported they filed grievances and never heard anything back regarding the concerns. The program's grievance policy states there will be follow up done with the client. When asked, leadership reported clients don't know the outcome of grievances. The program shall ensure they are following their own policy regarding grievances.**		
419-400-0140 Licensing Umbrella Rules: Records and Documentation, --- 2) All written or electronic entries in records required by the rules in OAR chapter 419, division 400 must be permanent, legible, dated, and signed by the person making the entry. **White-out was used on a medication administration record.**	**Yes✓ No☐**	White out was used on a medication administration record. The program shall ensure all records and documentation are permanent.

New Findings from Site Visit	Comments
None	

Interview Summary
Client #1: They have been at the program since June. They have been in several other programs in California and Utah, to include Provo Canyon School. Wilderness was “not it”. They liked the Heritage program the best. Most of the staff at this program are good; some staff are too strict. Their favorite staff is Destiny; she is a big advocate and listens to the clients. The food is ok, doesn’t like when they eat the food from the ranch. They like the snacks provided. They get enough to eat. Phone calls are once a week with their therapist. They are unsure if phone calls are allowed during the orientation phase. They get along with the other clients. They feel safe here. They would like to be able to move through treatment faster. Client #2: They have been at the program for one and a half months. They like it and believe it’s a better approach than other programs, but they get bored. They have been to eight other programs outside of Oregon. Staff here care about the welfare of the kids. It’s very clean, clients are expected to wash their hands before every meal. They like the food but don’t like the food from the ranch. They get along with the other clients, but everyone is so different; it can be hard to communicate. They go paddle boarding, Dutch Bros, the library and the Old Mill District on outings. They don’t have a trustworthy relationship with staff. Phone calls happen one time a week with staff. During the orientation phase, clients are not allowed phone calls. They would like leniency around chores.

Observations
The program currently has 11 clients. The program was clean and in good condition. Clients were cleaning up from lunch. Program leadership and CCLP discussed different strategies to allow clients private phone calls. There is an office, outside of the ktichen, that could be used for clients to have private phone calls.

Corrective Actions and Timeframes:

Please submit the following to verify compliance.

Within 45 days of receipt of this report **J Bar J – The Academy at Sisters** must submit a letter of verification indicating the agency is in compliance with the specific rules cited above and describing how compliance will be maintained going forward. Along with the letter of verification, the agency must submit any and all specific documentation requested in the body of this report. The letter of verification and any additional requested documents can be emailed directly to **Aubrey Kelly at Aubrey.J.Kelly@odhsoha.oregon.gov.**

Licensing Coordinator’s Signature: Aubrey Kelly Date: 11/04/2024

Manager Review: _____ Date: 10-29-2024